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This page keeps track of the money Gary sets aside for the grandchildren and the simple rules he follows so that gifts never touch the household reserve. Karen helps keep these notes current during her monthly visits.

Set Aside for Grandchildren

Grandchild	Occasion	Amount
Nate Dahl	Birthday, January	\$150.00
Emma Dahl	Birthday, March	\$150.00
Tyler Pittman	Birthday, February	\$150.00
College fund contributions	Annual	\$1,200.00

How It Works

Birthday money comes from the monthly surplus, set aside ahead of time so the gift is ready when the day arrives. The college contributions are made once a year and split evenly among the grandchildren. None of this comes from the savings reserve, which is kept separate for the house, the truck, and emergencies.

Notes

Karen visits once a month, sometimes more, and worries about her father being alone in the house. Jeff calls less often but shows up when it matters. The grandchildren, Nate, Emma, and Tyler, are the bright spot, and Gary likes knowing that a little is set aside for each of them.

Reserve balance of \$34,000.00 is held separately at Dacotah Bank and is never drawn for gifts.